intelligence and to send in air forces in coordination to strike these targets.

- Iraqi Kurds, to be made capable of achieving victory over ISIS, must be equipped with armored vehicles and a mobile artillery unit to give them room to maneuver and firepower, as well as coordinated air support.
- There is room to increase the number of American military advisers to support the Kurdish forces.
- To appease the Turks, who oppose any assistance to the Kurds, an agreement can be reached by which most of the heavy weapons supplied to the Kurds will be borrowed and returned to the United States with the end of the campaign against ISIS.
- The intelligence effort in producing targets, with the contribution of the Kurds, who are on the ground, will reduce collateral damage.

However, as important as eliminating ISIS is, it is not the number one challenge of today, nor was it then, at the end of 2015. Today, as then, we must focus our efforts on outlining the geostrategic architecture of the future—if you will, a new "Sykes-Picot model"—that will best serve the Middle East and the world. Once this architecture is defined, it will be possible to derive the optimal operational plan to achieve it. In other words, if a coalition goes to war against ISIS without having a clear plan for the day after the war, the results will be similar to those of the wars in Afghanistan, Iraq, and Libya.

It is true that in the Middle East arena there are too many cooks in the kitchen, from global and regional powers, to individual states both large and small, to terrorist gangs. It is not realistic to hope to find a common denominator that will satisfy all the interests of each player. Therefore, at the end of 2015 it seemed to me necessary and possible to reach a consensus that the most urgent priority was to eliminate the threat posed by ISIS, and that before embarking on this campaign, we had to form the contours of the Middle East as we wished it to emerge the day after the campaign. I will try to do this in the following paragraphs. As of 2017, this outline seemed even more likely to me than it did at the end of 2015.

The building blocks of the new Middle East, after a hundred years of the Middle East of Sykes-Picot, should in my opinion be as follows: